

Meeting Notes

Listing Page Merchandising Capabilities — H2s, Highlighted Refinements & Mega Menu Dashboard

Date: June 17, 2025

Attendees: Jerel Smith (Sr. PM, FIND), Daniel Ballas (Audio Merchandiser), Shalom Oster (Program Manager)

Topics: H2 copy on listing pages · Highlighted refinements · Mega menu dashboard · Mega menu tool demo

1 | Discussion Summary

A. H2 Copy on Listing Pages

The group aligned on adding short H2 descriptive text to select category listing pages. Purpose is dual: improve SEO keyword density and help customers understand page value to reduce bounce.

Key decisions reached:

- Tone: **Expert advisor** — authoritative but accessible, not salesy.
- Length: **One sentence / short tagline** preferred for consistency across categories.
- Not every listing page needs an H2; merchandisers choose based on domain expertise + GA4 signals.
- Selection criteria: (1) high bounce-rate categories, (2) high traffic / low conversion pages, (3) pages where customer education adds clear value — informed by merchandiser judgment.
- Scope to start: Photo, Video, Audio, and Lighting. Other categories (computers, sales) deferred to a second phase.

Content production workflow:

- **Merchandiser** → researches 3–5 SEO keywords and writes bullet-point guidance (or a rough draft sentence).
- **Jerel (PM)** → reviews draft with merchandiser, aligns on final direction, then hands to copy.
- **Alice Cronin (Copy)** → finalizes the sentence ensuring tone/style consistency across all categories.
- **NavArk / WebDesk (Fourth Floor)** → implements approved copy on the page via web ticket.
- Richard Stevens' team explicitly **excluded** from this workflow due to bandwidth and org constraints.
- SEO team consulted only if needed for keyword input; not required for every ticket.

Guardrails to formalize:

- Character/word count limit (UX to define).
- Standardized submission template so every merchandiser sends Alice the same format (keywords + bullet points, or full sentence draft).
- Keyword quantity: tentatively **3–5 keywords per category** — to be confirmed with SEO resource (Woudski).
- Tone brief to be shared with Alice once merchandising team aligns on it.

B. Highlighted Refinements

Highlighted refinements surface the top 3–5 most important filter questions a customer should answer on a category landing page (analogous to a salesperson's qualifying questions). Ellie's standing rule: if an *Application* refinement exists for the category, it must appear first.

- Up to the merchandiser which categories get highlighted refinements — not mandatory, not chasing a number quota.

- Low-level or seasonal categories can qualify (e.g. solar-observing category during an eclipse event).
- Should be treated as a **narrative pair with the H2** — the H2 sets context; highlighted refinements give customers an immediate actionable path into the page.
- Implementation ticket goes to WebDesk (same as H2 tickets).
- Highlighted refinements are expected to take longer to prepare than H2 copy, so sequencing is: H2 first, refinements follow.

Measurement strategy — phased rollout:

- **Phase 1 (H2 only, 30–60 days):** Establish baseline impact on bounce rate, ATC, CVR, revenue.
- **Phase 2 (Add highlighted refinements):** Layered onto H2 pages — measure delta vs. Phase 1 baseline.
- This prevents variable inflation — if both ship simultaneously, attribution is impossible.
- Merchandisers define which metrics they care about; Jerel maps those to available GA4 data.

C. Ticket / Workflow Structure (Shalom)

- **One parent ticket** per initiative (H2, Highlighted Refinements).
- **Sub-tickets per merchandising team** (Audio sub-ticket, Photo/Video sub-ticket, etc.) so individual teams can close when done without waiting on others.
- Inaugural Audio sub-ticket for Daniel to pilot the process end-to-end.
- Separate ticket required if 'View All' functionality or Explorer buying-guide links are in scope (those route to CTV/WebDesk, not the same ticket as H2 copy).
- Future state (once workflow is established): merchandisers submit content requests directly to Alice and WebDesk — Jerel's oversight only needed for initial calibration.

D. Mega Menu Impact Dashboard

Jerel demoed the in-progress Mega Menu Impact Dashboard toward the end of the meeting. Key concepts reviewed:

- **Baseline period:** First 30 days post-launch (control → expansive design) used to establish slot-level CTR norms before any merchandiser experiments begin.
- **Two baseline types:** (1) slot-specific across all categories, (2) slot + category-specific — both needed to contextualize future experiments correctly.
- **Experiment lens:** Dashboard scoped to L1 category (e.g. Pro Audio). Changes in unrelated categories are intentionally excluded from each category's view.
- **Guardrail suggestion:** Limit number of simultaneous slot changes per period to avoid measurement noise.
- **Hypothesis-logging discipline:** Merchandisers should record expected impact before making changes (e.g., 'Moving drones from slot 1→4 should improve CTR on tripods by ~X%') — builds institutional memory even when predictions miss.
- **Hover-dwell metric:** Will be tracked; high dwell after certain changes signals a possible UX confusion signal worth investigating.
- All slot-change data dumps into data warehouse for ad-hoc analysis downstream.
- Matthew Reinhardt (BI/DW) confirmed technical feasibility in first meeting; mock-up requested.
- Josh Brown also looped in on dashboard direction.

E. Mega Menu Merch Tool

- Jerel showed Daniel the current merch tool — export functionality is ready.
- Daniel to use the tool to configure his Audio category slot assignments, then export the multi-tab spreadsheet (L1, L2, L3, L4 tabs) for review.
- Buying-guide associations (Explorer links) will require a **separate** WebDesk/CTV ticket — not bundled with slot-assignment export.
- Goal: get Daniel comfortable with the tool so he can pilot it and set the expectation for other merchandisers.

F. View All on Category Landing Pages (Awareness Item)

Jerel flagged the upcoming 'View All' functionality on category landing pages (currently in-sprint / imminent launch). Not a primary action item from this meeting but merchandisers should be aware:

- Merchandisers will eventually need to audit category landing pages and decide which buckets benefit from a 'View All' entry point.
- Lower traffic than SRPs/PLPs — treat as a later audit task, not a near-term sprint item.
- When go-live happens, the page layout will update; no automatic 'View All' will be added — it requires a deliberate decision.

G. Holiday Context

- Audio team will be involved in holiday planning to some degree — specifics TBD.
- Holiday Hub (gifts-by-use-case page) likely behaves differently from standard listing pages; H2 / highlighted refinements may not apply — **Laura to clarify** whether holiday Hub pages are standard CDPs or custom.
- Normal listing page work (H2, refinements) should still proceed — most holiday shopping will continue on standard category pages, not just the Hub.
- Refined refinements not seen as useful for Holiday Hub pages given the curated, cross-category nature.

2 | Next Steps & Action Items

Action Item	Owner	Target
Go through Pro Audio category list top-to-bottom; select inaugural 5 (±) listing pages for H2 copy. Document reasoning (domain expertise + GA4 signals).	Daniel Ballas	~2 weeks
For each selected Audio category: research 3–5 SEO keywords and write bullet-point guidance (or a full draft sentence) per the agreed submission format.	Daniel Ballas	~2 weeks
Create parent H2 ticket + Audio sub-ticket in MRCH system. Define sub-ticket structure for Photo, Video, and Lighting teams to follow.	Shalom Oster	This week
Draft standardized merch-to-copy submission template (fields: category name, target keywords x3–5, bullet-point guidance, optional draft sentence, tone notes). Share with team before first submission.	Jerel Smith	This week
Confirm keyword quantity guardrail (3–5 proposed) with SEO resource (Woudski). Update merch ticket template once confirmed.	Jerel Smith	This week

Action Item	Owner	Target
Align merchandising team on H2 tone brief (expert advisor, short tagline). Share with Alice Cronin so she has consistent direction from day one.	Jerel Smith + Merch leads	Before first submission
Review Daniel's Audio H2 draft; iterate collaboratively; finalize copy. Hand finalized copy to Alice Cronin for polish.	Jerel Smith	~2 weeks post-Daniel draft
Begin using the Mega Menu Merch Tool: configure Audio slot assignments, run export, share multi-tab spreadsheet with Jerel for review.	Daniel Ballas	Ongoing / next touchpoint
Clarify whether Holiday Hub pages behave as standard CDPs (and thus support H2 / highlighted refinements). Confirm with Laura.	Jerel Smith	ASAP
Schedule follow-up working session once Audio H2 tickets are created to get the content workflow officially rolling.	Shalom Oster	~2 weeks
Highlighted refinements: defer until H2 Phase 1 baseline is established (30–60 days post H2 launch). Revisit as next initiative.	All	Post H2 launch
Mega Menu dashboard mock-up: continue coordination with Matthew Reinhardt (BI/DW) on feasibility and data contract. Josh Brown also looped in.	Jerel Smith	Ongoing
View All on landing pages: no immediate action. Merchandisers to audit categories after the feature goes live (imminent NavArk sprint).	Daniel Ballas + Merch team	Post-launch audit

3 | Key Open Questions

Topic	Question	Owner
Holiday Hub page type	Are Holiday Hub pages standard CDPs? Do H2 and highlighted refinements apply?	Laura
Keyword guardrail	Is 3–5 SEO keywords the right ceiling to give Alice, or does Woudski recommend a different count?	Jerel + Woudski
Submission template	What exact fields should the merch-to-copy template require to ensure Alice always receives consistent input?	Jerel
Bounce rate definition	Does B&H's GA4 implementation define bounce as time-based or engagement-based? Matters for how we set success metrics.	Jerel / Analytics
Holiday bandwidth	How much of Daniel's capacity will holiday planning consume? Affects H2 timeline for Audio.	Daniel + Ellie
Computers / Sales categories	Computers team is understaffed. Who picks up H2 work when a new merchandiser joins in July?	Ellie / Shalom

4 | Timeline Snapshot

When	Milestone
This week	Shalom creates parent H2 ticket + Audio sub-ticket. Jerel circulates submission template + tone brief.
~2 weeks (~July 1)	Daniel delivers inaugural Audio H2 list (5±), keywords, and blurb guidance. Working session to review.
End of July	Target: H2 copy finalized, approved, and submitted to Alice. WebDesk ticket filed for implementation.
30–60 days post-H2 launch	Establish H2 performance baseline. Begin scoping Highlighted Refinements Phase 2.
Holiday season	H2 capabilities available for use on standard listing pages. Holiday Hub scope TBD (pending Laura's clarification).

Notes compiled by Jerel Smith, FIND Team — B&H; Photo. Distribution: Daniel Ballas, Shalom Oster. Internal use only.